



Philips HTS3105 Value For Money

How thoughtful of Philips to include a 6 channel speaker setup with their new HTS3105 DVD player. Yes! its another bundle product, meaning you have a surround sound setup to watch those DVD's right out of the box. Supporting multiple video and audio formats this sturdy looking player is suitably feature rich (remote control, FM radio).

The 500W RMS speakers distort slightly at higher volumes (above 75 per cent). The subwoofer is decent, but lacks the depth necessary to go really low. The satellites deliver decent reproduction throughout the spectrum, but can't handle high volumes at all. The overall sound experience was, to sum it up, a touch weak considering the on-paper specifications. Our test DVD movies did sound good, but only at lower volumes.

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Web site: : www.philips.co.in
Price: Rs.14,999



Overall a mediocre product, simply because at 14,999, (its price), you can easily buy a DVD player and good set of 5.1 speakers. Even the inclusion of FM doesn't do too much to sweeten the deal. Go for this only if you want the convenience of everything in one package.

Specifications

Player: DVD/DivX/VCD/Music (multi-format) player, FM/AM radio inbuilt. Speakers: 5.1 surround, 500 W RMS (4 x 75 W + centre 100 W + subwoofer 100 W)

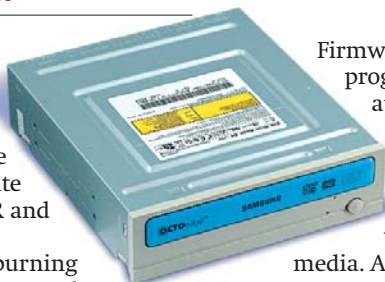
RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★●
Features	★★★★●
Ease of use	★★★★●
Value for money	★★★★●
Overall	★★★★●

Samsung SH-S182D 18X Super-WriteMaster Spinning Faster

The Samsung SH-S182D is the newest DVD-Writer from Samsung and also the fastest, sporting a write speed of 18x to DVD-R and DVD+R media. It also supports high-speed burning of dual-layer DVDs at 8x, and 12x DVD-RAM burning—the highest available today.

The drive successfully read scratched CDs and DVDs. We tried overburning, but found that only CDs could be overburned, not DVDs. Due to the lack of 18x media, we could not test this drive's 18x burning speed.

The drive comes with an extra black bezel for those with black cabinets. Included with it is the Samsung



Firmware LiveUpdate program, which enables automatic firmware update online. The feature missing here is LightScribe, but then again, it's hard to find LightScribe media. All in all, a good drive!

Specifications

2 MB buffer, write speeds: DVD+-R: 18x, DVD+-R DL: 8x, DVD+RW: 8x, DVD-RW: 6x, DVD-RAM: 12x, CD-R: 48x, CD-RW: 32x, read speeds: DVD+-R: 12x, DVD+-R DL: 8x, DVD+RW: 8x, DVD-RAM: 12x, DVD-ROM: 16x, CD-R: 40x, CD-RW: 40x, CD-ROM: 48x

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: Samsung India Electronics Pvt Ltd
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Price: Rs 3,000

Aiptek mini PocketDV 8900

...Master Of None

The Aiptek mini PocketDV 8900 is a compact, pocket-able DV camera. The body is made of plastic, and does not appear very rugged. The 2-inch swivel LCD is of no use on outdoor shoots—it is almost impossible to view in daylight. Video capture resolution is only 640 x 480 at 30 fps, so forget about capturing DVD-quality movies. But the videos weren't that bad, after all. It can capture still photos at up to 5 MP, which can be interpolated to 10 MP—but the quality was nowhere near even what a 3 MP camera delivers: too much noise. There is no optical zoom, but thankfully, the autofocus works very well.

The PocketDV can also play MP3 and WAV, ASF video, and can display JPEG photos. You can even record voice and use the voice-canceling feature to turn it into a Karaoke machine. It can also be used as a Web cam. The 22 MB of inbuilt Flash memory is insufficient, but an SD/MMC card slot is provided to augment storage capacity.

The 8900 comes bundled with loads of accessories. A remote is provided, and so are cables to connect it to a TV. A carry pouch and a pair of earphones are also comes along. Aiptek even included an almost-unusable mini tripod. The bundled software suite from ArcSoft is decent.

Specifications

5 MP still photo, videos at 640 x 480 at 30 fps, 2-inch LCD viewfinder, video format: ASF, audio formats: MP3 and WAV, 22 MB internal memory, SD/MMC card support

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★●
Features	★★★★●
Ease of use	★★★★●
Value for money	★★★★●
Overall	★★★★●

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Price: Rs 16,500 (special introductory price Rs 9,995)

